

Zaher Karp, MPH

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Research Interests

Healthcare data engineering and analytics in regulated environments. Particular focus on CMS Medicare Stars and HEDIS quality measurement, forecasting under regulatory constraints, and the design of compliant, governed data platforms. Earlier work in health services research on primary care systems, EHR optimization, and accountable care.

Education

2015 Master of Public Health, Biostatistics. University of Wisconsin–Madison.

2015 Graduate Certificate, Patient Safety (Industrial and Systems Engineering). University of Wisconsin–Madison.

2007 Bachelor of Arts, English Literature. University of Wisconsin–Madison.

Appointments

2025–present Baltimore Health Analytics, Manager of Data Science and Engineering. Owns the data platform for a Medicare Advantage analytics product, including the regulatory validation layer against CMS technical specifications, and leads a distributed engineering and QA team.

2017–2025 Healthfinch (acquired by Health Catalyst), Analytics Manager. Built and led the analytics data platform supporting value-based care across more than fifty health systems, including the infrastructure migration following the Health Catalyst acquisition.

2009–2018 University of Wisconsin–Madison, Researcher and Research Specialist. Quantitative and qualitative analysis for federally funded health services research in primary care, co-authoring peer-reviewed publications and supporting AHRQ, NIH, and PCORI grants.

Publications

1. Karp Z, Kamnetz S, Wietfeldt N, Sinsky C, Molfetter T, Pandhi N. Influence of environmental design on team interactions across 3 family medicine clinics. *Health Environments Research & Design Journal*. 2019;12(4):159–173. PMID: 30913920. Cited 12 times.
2. Pandhi N, Gaines ME, Deci D, Schlesinger M, Culp C, Karp Z et al. Broadening medical students' exposure to the range of illness experiences: a pilot experimental curriculum trial. *Academic Medicine*. 2019. PMID: 31348072. Cited 4 times.
3. Berkson S, Davis S, Karp Z, Jaffery J, Flood G, Pandhi N. Medicare Shared Savings Programs: higher cost accountable care organizations are more likely to achieve savings. *International Journal of Healthcare Management*. 2018.
4. Pandhi N, Jacobson N, Serrano N, Hernandez A, Zeidler-Schreiter E, Wietfeldt N, Karp Z. An efficient process of gathering diverse community opinions to inform an intervention. *Implementation Science*. 2016;11(Suppl 1):A13.
5. Pandhi N, Yang WL, Karp Z, Young A, Beasley JW, Kraft S, Carayon P. Approaches and challenges to optimizing primary care teams' electronic health record usage. *Journal of Innovation in Health Informatics*. 2014;21(3):142–51. PMID: 25584902. Cited 24 times.
6. Yang W, Pandhi N, Karp Z, Young A, Beasley J, Kraft S, Carayon P. Approaches and challenges to optimizing the use of EHRs in primary care (preliminary findings). *Proceedings of World Conference on E-Learning, Montréal*. 2012.

Presentations

Seventeen podium presentations, workshops, and posters at national and regional venues between 2010 and 2017, in healthcare services research and primary care systems engineering. A co-authored poster received the Patient Choice Award (2 of 45) at the North American Primary Care Research Group Conference, 2015.

2017 National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering. Madison, WI.

2017 UW Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, Dissemination and Implementation Short Course. Madison, WI.

2016 AAMC Integrating Quality Meeting. Chicago, IL.

2016 National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering. Madison, WI.

2015 Field Innovation Team's Bootcamp. Provo, UT.

2015 Access, Quality, and Outcomes Research Network. Appleton, WI.

2015 Society for Implementation Research Collaboration Conference. Seattle, WA.

2015 National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering. Madison, WI.

2015 UW Health Quality Week. Madison, WI.

2015 North American Primary Care Research Group Conference. Cancún, Mexico.

2015 Wisconsin Research and Education Network Convocation of Practices. Oshkosh, WI.

2014 National Collaborative for Improving Primary Care Through Industrial and Systems Engineering. Madison, WI.

2014 AAMC Integrating Quality Meeting. Chicago, IL.

2014 Pharmacy Society of Wisconsin Annual Meeting. Madison, WI.

2012 World Conference on E-Learning in Corporate, Government, Healthcare, and Higher Education. Montréal, QC.

2012 UW Health organizational leadership. Middleton, WI.

2010 Wisconsin Primary Care Research and Quality Improvement Forum. Middleton, WI.

Grants and Funding

Contributed quantitative and qualitative analysis to more than \$250,000 in federal research funding from the Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (AHRQ), the National Institutes of Health (NIH), and the Patient-Centered Outcomes Research Institute (PCORI), supporting studies of primary care redesign, EHR optimization, and accountable care performance.

Awards and Honors

2017 Alumni Hall Service Award, University of Wisconsin-Madison.

2015 Patient Choice Award (2 of 45), North American Primary Care Research Group Conference.

Service and Professional Activities

2019–present Peer reviewer for healthcare services and informatics journals.

2016–2020 Board member, The Road Home Dane County.

2014–2017 Undergraduate research mentor, University of Wisconsin–Madison.

2013–2015 Board chair, WORT 89.9 FM community radio.

2015 Lean Six Sigma certification.

Technical Skills

Data platform: SQL (Postgres, SQL Server, MySQL, MariaDB), Python (pandas, PySpark), dbt, Airflow, Docker, AWS, Azure, Databricks, Tableau, Sisense, R, git

Healthcare domain: HEDIS, CMS Medicare Stars, HIPAA, HITRUST, EHR systems (Epic Clarity, Cerner, Veradigm, athenahealth), FHIR, HL7, value-based care, ACO / MSSP

Research methods: biostatistics, interrupted time series, mixed-methods study design, qualitative coding (NVivo), survey instrumentation (Qualtrics), SAS, Stata